PRAXIS

Responsible Procurement Policy

What we ask of the people we buy from, what we will not buy at any price, and where our influence runs out.

Issued by	Praxis Brands Ltd, trading as Stennah & Hope, company no. 17222158
Applies to	Everything we buy, at two levels. Section 4 applies to every purchase without exception. Section 3 applies to production inputs — wax, fragrance, vessels, wicks, packaging and contract manufacturing — and to transport, distribution and warehousing. Section 7 sets out when it applies to everything else.
Accountable	The Board of Directors, which does not delegate accountability for this Policy
Read with	Human Rights Commitment; JEDI Commitment; Stakeholder Grievance Procedure; Procurement Impact Assessment (HR4.2–4.3 / ESC5.1–5.2)
Version / date	1.0 — adopted by the Board on 21 October 2026
Review	Every 12 months from adoption — next review by 21 October 2027

1. Why this is written plainly

We are a small manufacturer buying at small volumes. Price decides most of what we do, and a policy that claimed otherwise would be worth nothing to the people it is meant to protect.

So this Policy does not say that human rights outweigh cost in our purchasing. It says something narrower and truer: **there are things we will not buy at any price, there are questions we ask before we buy, and there is a record of the answers.** Within those limits, we buy on price.

2. How price and human rights actually meet here

The checks in section 3 are thresholds, not preferences. A supplier either clears them or does not. Being cheap does not clear them.

Between suppliers who clear them, we choose on price, quality and reliability. We do not pretend to run a scoring system that weighs human rights against cost.

We do not press a supplier to a price we can see is only achievable by underpaying people. Where a quote is far below the rest of the market, we ask how.

Where a supplier fails a check and no alternative exists, we record that, say so in our Human Rights Commitment, and keep looking. We do not quietly carry on and call it compliance.

Where we are the only buyer who could reasonably switch and we choose not to, that is a decision, and we record it as one.

3. What we ask before appointing a supplier

These questions go to every prospective supplier of production inputs and of transport, distribution or warehousing, and to our existing suppliers in those categories. We ask for answers in writing, and we keep them.

1. Where are the goods you supply to us made, compounded or assembled? For transport, which legs of the journey do you operate yourself?
2. Do you subcontract any part of that work, and if so, to whom and where?
3. Do you confirm that no forced, bonded or child labour is used in producing or moving what you supply to us?
4. Do you meet the legal minimum wage and working time rules everywhere you operate? For transport, this includes drivers' hours and rest rules, and the status under which your drivers are engaged.
5. Are you a member of SEDEX, or subject to any independent ethical audit? If so, what was the date and outcome of the most recent one?
6. For materials with known human rights **or environmental** risk in their supply chains — palm, mica, soy, cotton — do you hold certification, and which scheme and supply chain model does it cover? We distinguish schemes that trace the physical material from those that work on a mass-balance or credit basis, because only the first tells us about the material we actually receive.
7. How can someone working for you raise a concern about their treatment?
8. Do you hold environmental certification, or operate an environmental management system such as ISO 14001, and what does it cover?
9. What are the most significant environmental impacts of what you supply to us — in energy, water, waste, emissions, packaging or land use — and what are you doing about them?

These questions are the evidence, not this document. A completed answer from each supplier, dated and filed, is what shows the Policy is applied.

Questions 1 to 7 address human rights; questions 6, 8 and 9 address environmental impact. Question 6 does both, because palm, soy and cotton carry each kind of risk at once and asking about them separately would invite two different answers about one material.

4. What we will not buy

These are refusals, not preferences. They apply to every purchase we make, whatever the saving, and whether or not the purchase is a production input.

- Goods or services where there is credible evidence of forced, bonded or child labour anywhere we can see in the chain.
- Goods from a supplier who will not tell us where they are made.
- Goods or services from a supplier we know to be in breach of minimum wage law.
- Goods or services from a supplier who retaliates against a worker for raising a concern, where we know of it.
- Goods containing palm, soy or cotton where the supplier will not tell us whether the material is certified, and under which scheme.
- Goods or services from a supplier we know to be in breach of environmental law, or subject to an unresolved enforcement notice from an environmental regulator.

5. When we cannot get an answer

Our orders are small and our influence is limited. A supplier may decline to answer, and we may have no practical alternative to buying from them anyway.

When that happens we record what we asked, what we were told, and the date. We ask again at the annual review. We prefer, at equal price, the supplier who answered. And we disclose the gap in our Human Rights Commitment rather than leaving the impression that we know more than we do.

6. Our existing suppliers

The questions in section 3 apply to suppliers we already use, not only to new ones. Answers are recorded in our supplier register, which holds one row for each supplier: what they supply, what they have confirmed, the date of confirmation, and when the question is next asked.

The register is reviewed once a year by the Board, alongside this Policy and alongside the Procurement Impact Assessment.

7. Purchases outside production and transport

For everything else we buy — equipment, services, office supplies, professional advice — **section 4 always applies.** There is no purchase to which the refusals do not apply.

The full section 3 questions apply in addition wherever any one of the following is true:

- the supplier provides workers to us, or labour of any kind carried out on our behalf;
- the goods are manufactured outside the UK or the EU;
- our spend with that supplier exceeds £5,000 in a financial year.

Below those triggers we apply section 4 and nothing further. We set the line here because a threshold we would not police is worse than an honest one we will. The Board reviews the £5,000 figure annually and records any change.

8. How we decide what matters most

Once a year we assess the **actual and potential** negative human rights **and environmental** impacts of our most material procurement decisions, using severity and likelihood, and we record the result in the Procurement Impact Assessment. Materiality is judged on spend together with the severity and likelihood of potential negative impact.

The environmental impacts we consider include climate impacts, water use, pollution, waste generation, biodiversity loss, deforestation, resource extraction and animal welfare. Each procurement decision is recorded as carrying an **actual** or a **potential** environmental risk, and the Assessment states which.

For 2026 the four most material procurement decisions are:

Rank	Procurement decision	Share of spend	Risk score
1	Wax — soy, coconut, beeswax, palm	50%	9 (High)
2	Fragrance oils	30%	6 (Medium)
3	Shipping, transport and distribution	20%	9 (High)
4	Wicks — cotton	To confirm	9 (High)

The first three shares are stated as a proportion of procurement spend and total 100 per cent. Wicks are the smallest of the four by cost; their share is established and all four restated at the next review.

Wicks are assessed because of severity, not spend. B Lab's guidance treats any one of the materiality categories as sufficient, and cotton is among the highest-risk commodities in world trade for forced labour. A procurement decision is not minor because it is cheap.

The mitigation actions arising from that assessment are recorded in it, reviewed by the Board, and carried into the following year's assessment with a note on whether each proved effective.

9. What we do not yet do

- **We do not audit our suppliers.** We rely on what they tell us in writing and on any independent audit they already hold.
- **We have no supplier code of conduct written into our contracts.** Our purchasing terms do not yet carry human rights clauses.
- **We have not yet assessed our most significant human rights risks across the business.** The Procurement Impact Assessment covers our material procurement decisions; it is not a whole-business risk assessment, which remains committed for Q3 2027.
- **We have not verified what our employment agency pays the workers it places with us.**
- **We have not yet asked any carrier the questions in section 3.** Transport was outside the scope of the earlier draft of this Policy. Bringing it into scope is the change this revision makes, and the questions follow.
- **We have not obtained the RSPO certificate** our wax supplier states it holds, or established which supply chain model it covers.
- **We had asked no supplier an environmental question until this revision.** Questions 8 and 9, and the environmental limb of question 6, are new on 21 October 2026. Nothing has yet been asked under them and nothing has yet been answered.
- **We hold no environmental data from any supplier** — no energy, water, waste or emissions figures for anything we buy. Our assessment of environmental impact rests on what is known about these materials and routes in general, not on what our own suppliers have told us.
- **Our purchasing terms carry no environmental clauses,** as they carry no human rights clauses.

10. Accountability

Purchasing decisions are made by the Managing Director. Accountability for this Policy rests with the Board, which does not delegate it. The Board reviews the supplier register, the Procurement Impact Assessment and this Policy at least once a year, records where the Policy has not been followed and why, and answers for that to anyone affected by it.

Anyone affected by our purchasing — including a worker employed by one of our suppliers — may raise a concern through our published Stakeholder Grievance Procedure, including anonymously, without detriment for doing so.

11. Status of this Policy

This Policy supports two impact topics under B Lab's V2 standards: Human Rights, in particular HR4, and Environmental Stewardship & Circularity, in particular ESC5 — the consideration of actual and potential environmental impacts in procurement decisions. It is read alongside our Human Rights Commitment and our Climate Action Plan.

It is **available on request** to anyone affected by our purchasing, including workers employed by our suppliers.

The Board's intention is to publish it at praxisbrands.co.uk alongside the Human Rights Commitment. Until that page exists we do not describe this Policy as published, and the publication date is recorded as a dated commitment rather than stated as done.

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